

22 TOWNS AND PLACES



My home is not a place, it is people.

Lois McMaster Bujold

The world is a book and those who do not travel read only one page.

St. Augustine

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **world:** globe, in the north, in the south, in the east, in the west, the North Pole, oceans (the Atlantic Ocean, the Indian Ocean, the Pacific Ocean), continent, state, sea (the Mediterranean Sea, the Baltic Sea, the Dead Sea), peninsula, island, coast, cliffs, bay, harbour, beach, gulf, river, lake, loch, pond, channel, waterfalls, geyser, thermal springs, climatic zones, fauna and flora, protected animals, endangered species, forests, rainforests, jungle, volcano, desert, plains, lowlands, caves, canyon, moorland, glacier, the Alps, the High Tatras, the Low Tatras, mountains, hills, peak, vast area, Seven Wonders of the World
- **urban areas:** metropolis, megalopolis, megacity, global city, city, town, suburb, outskirts
 - industrial, hectic, administrative, financial, trade, residential, distant, convenient
 - landmarks, skyscrapers, infrastructure (roads, rails, metro system), housing estate, shopping centres, business centres, cultural events, sports facilities, job opportunities, tourism, sights, sightseeing
- **rural areas:** country, countryside, village, hamlet
 - peace, safety, solitude, farming, growing plants
- **attractions for tourists:**
 - ruins, castle, palace, cathedral, church, museum, gallery, statue, tower, bridge, clock, historic building, tomb, altar, gate, route, well, fountain, spa
 - abandoned, ancient, breathtaking, distant, eye-catching, historical, medieval, protected, splendid, unique, reconstructed, damaged, ruined, decorated, preserved, protected, densely/thinly populated, hilly, mountainous, sandy, stony
 - bird's view, landscape, to take a picture/photo/snapshot, to record with a camera/camcorder

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. Where do you live? What makes the place where you live special for you?
2. What advantages and disadvantages are there of living in towns?
3. What advantages and disadvantages are there of living in the country?
4. Which activities can people do in towns/cities and in the country?
5. Where do you think the most dangerous places in the world are? Why?

6. Which destinations are unreachable? Why?
7. Describe the place you have been to that you like most.
8. Which town or place in the world would you most like to visit one day? Why?
9. Which towns or places do you consider to be "Wonders of the World"?
10. Why do some people travel on their own as backpackers? Would you like to try it too?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

REASONS FOR PEOPLE'S MIGRATION

There are many beautiful places in the world where people would like to live or **at least** spend their holiday. Some people like the **tranquillity** and **peacefulness** of the countryside. Others prefer **leading** a hectic life in **crowded** towns and cities. **Nowadays**, it is quite normal for people to live in different places during their lives. Moving is often connected with work, education and marriage. Adapting to a new place and **assimilation** may take some time. On the other hand, there are people who spend all their lives in one place. They do not have any personal, financial or other **reasons** for leaving home. **From time to time**, we all leave our homes when we travel away for holiday.

1. According to the text, what are common reasons for people moving home?
2. What are the advantages and disadvantages of moving from place to place?

THE MOST BEAUTIFUL TOWNS AND PLACES

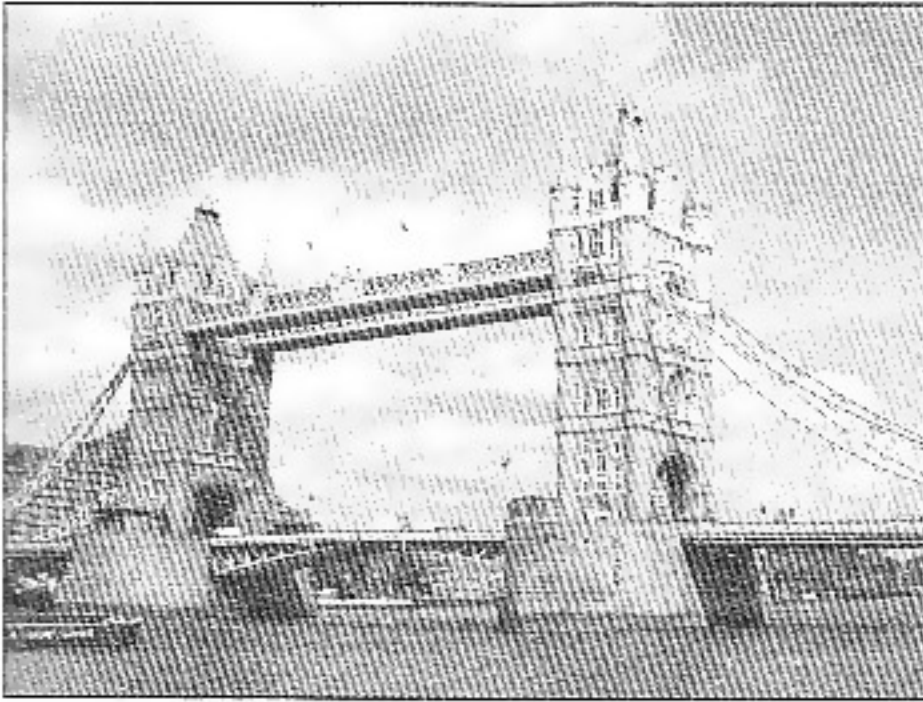
There are many beautiful places in the world. Some of them are surprising, inspiring and exciting. The most beautiful cities of the world might include Prague, Barcelona, Hong Kong, Istanbul, Jerusalem, London, New York, Paris, Rio de Janeiro, San Francisco, Venice **along with** many others. They offer a lot of **excitement**, possibilities for sightseeing, shopping opportunities in the most luxurious shops, as well as **a wide range of** restaurants, casinos and night clubs. The Hawaiian Islands, the Seychelles and the Pacific Islands are called "**paradise**" places. They are preferred by those who look for the exotic and relaxation. The **unbounded** countryside of the Alps, New Zealand, Coastal Norway and Tuscany offer a lot of **adventure**. Antarctica, the Amazon, the Canadian Rockies, the Galápagos Islands, the Grand Canyon and the Sahara are some of the most beautiful **wild** places in the world. They are popular especially among nature lovers. The **wonders** of the world, such as the Acropolis, the Giza Pyramids, the Great Wall, Angkor, Machu Picchu and the Taj Mahal, are perhaps the most **mysterious** places in the world.

3. What do the cities mentioned in the text offer tourists?
4. Which towns and places mentioned in the text above have you been to?

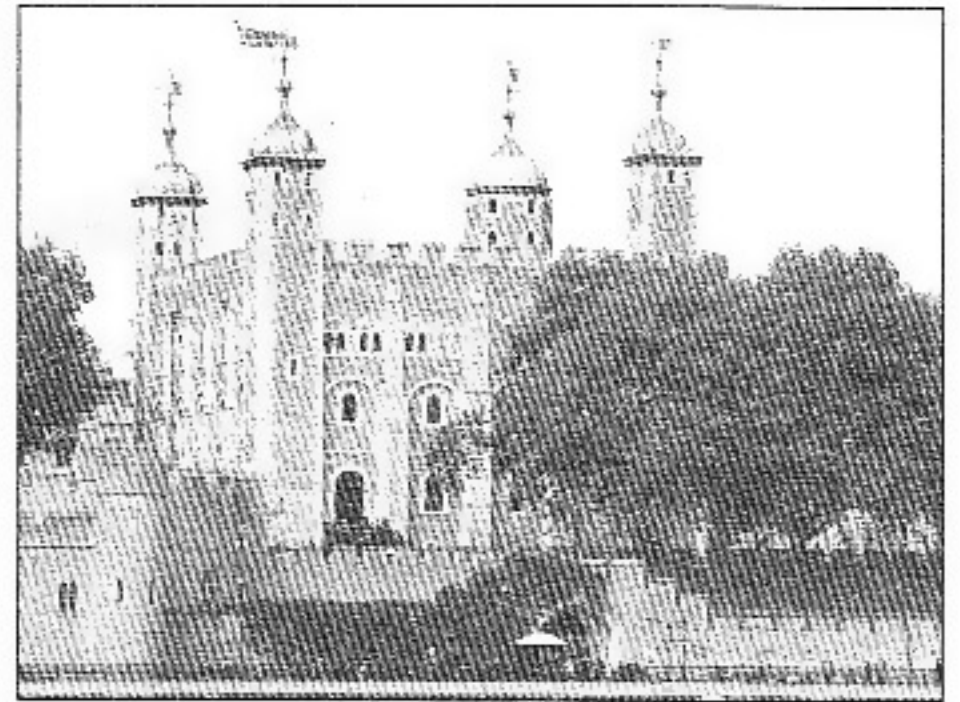
LONDON

London is the capital of England and of Great Britain. It is a city of traditions, historic buildings, monuments, theatres, parks and interesting museums. It is the biggest city in Europe.

On the *River Thames*, there is *Tower Bridge* and *the Tower*, which are visited by many tourists. In the past, The Tower of London was a **fortress**, a royal palace and a prison. Now, the Tower is a museum of **arms** and the place where the **crown jewels** are kept.



Tower Bridge

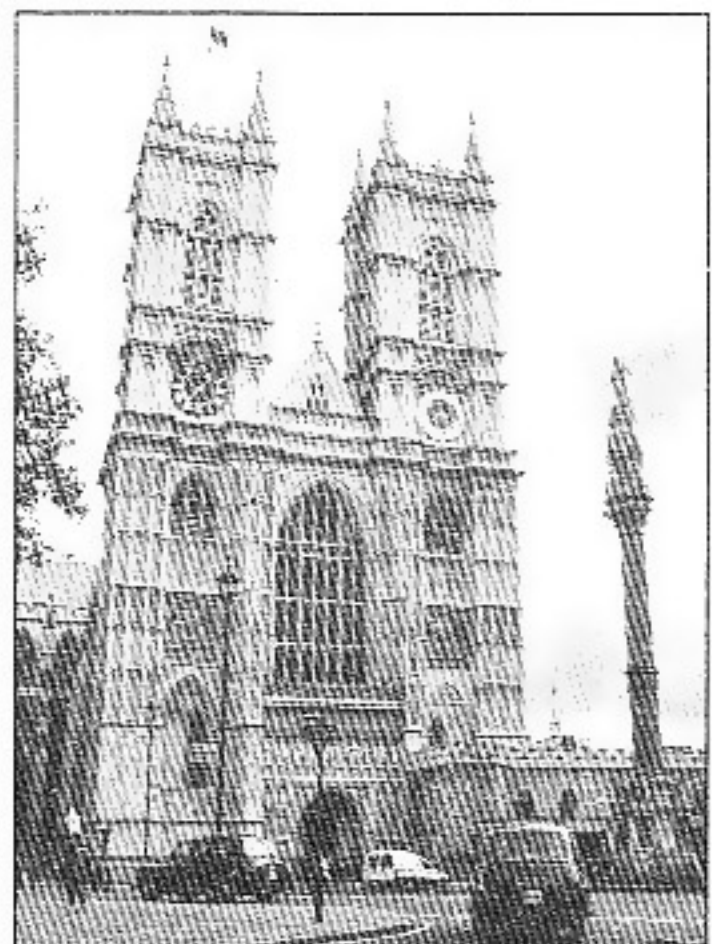


The Tower

There are many beautiful churches in London. *St. Paul's Cathedral* is the greatest of English churches. It was built by the famous English architect, Sir Christopher Wren. Wellington, Nelson and many other great British figures are **buried** there. *Westminster Abbey* is the **coronation** church of almost all English monarchs and most of them are buried there.



St. Paul's Cathedral



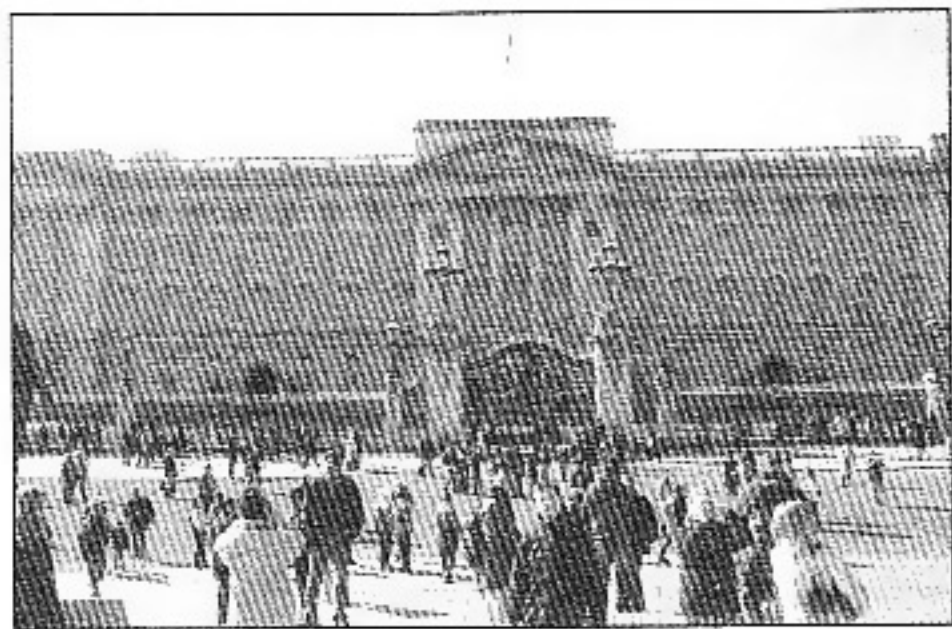
Westminster Abbey

The Palace of Westminster, also known as *The Houses of Parliament*, is the seat of the British Parliament. When Parliament is **in session**, a flag flies at the top of the *Big Ben* clock tower, which is famous for its **accuracy** and for its 13-tonne bell, which is **nick-named** "Big Ben".

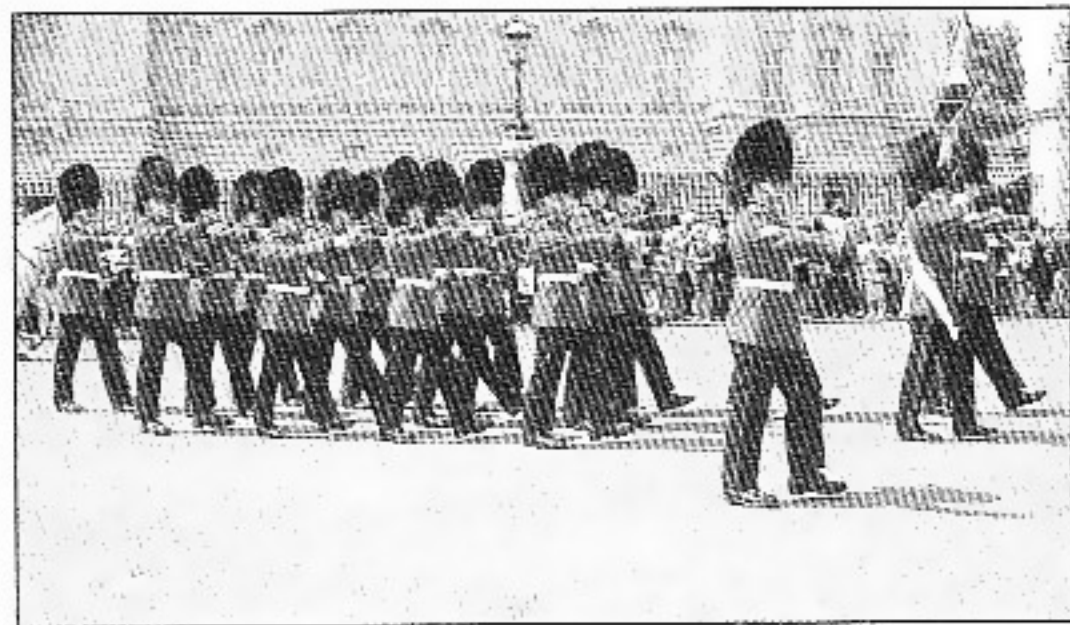


The Houses of Parliament, Big Ben

Another place of interest for visitors in London is *Buckingham Palace*, the London residence of the British royal family. Every day at 11:30, the Queen's Guard in uniform perform the ceremony of the Changing of the Guards.

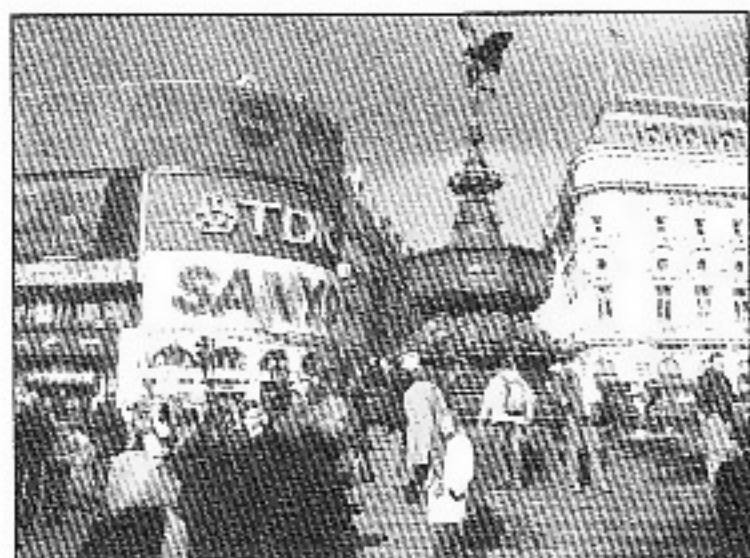


Buckingham Palace



Changing of the Guards

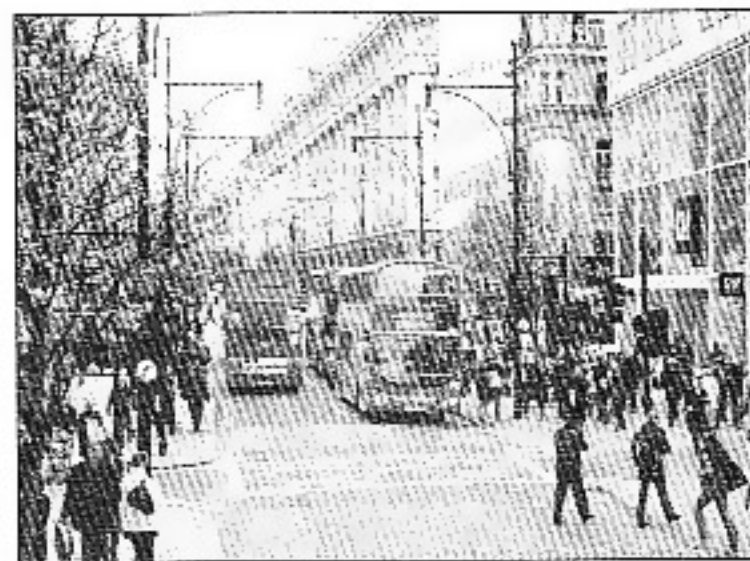
The most famous streets for their shops and entertainment are *Piccadilly*, *Bond Street*, *Regent's Street*, *Carnaby Street* and *Oxford Street*. In the centre of Piccadilly Circus there is the *Statue of Eros* (God of Love). One of the largest London squares is *Trafalgar Square* with its statue of Admiral Nelson in the centre.



Piccadilly Circus



Trafalgar Square



Oxford Street

The National Gallery contains Britain's best-known collection of paintings. *The Tate Gallery* is another big gallery containing modern art. Visitors of *Madame Tussaud's* can see **waxworks** of famous people from all over the world.



Madame Tussauds Wax Museum

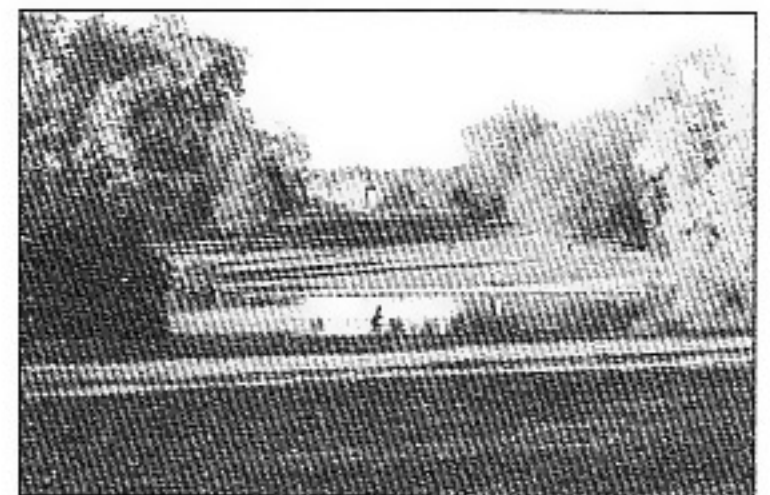
London has a large number of parks and gardens. The best-known are *St. James's Park*, *Buckingham Palace Gardens*, *Hyde Park*, *Regent's Park* and *Kensington Gardens*. Hyde Park is the largest of the royal parks. It has many attractions **including** a small lake and Speaker's Corner, where anybody can make a public **speech** about any topic but not about the Queen.



**Speakers' Corner
at Hyde Park**



Regent's Park



Kensington Gardens

5. Which places would you visit in London if you wanted to see the:
 - wax figures of famous people,
 - the crown jewels,
 - modern works of art?
6. What does it mean when the flag is risen on Big Ben?
7. What is Buckingham Palace famous for?
8. Where can you find Speaker's Corner?
9. Where would you go shopping in London?

WASHINGTON

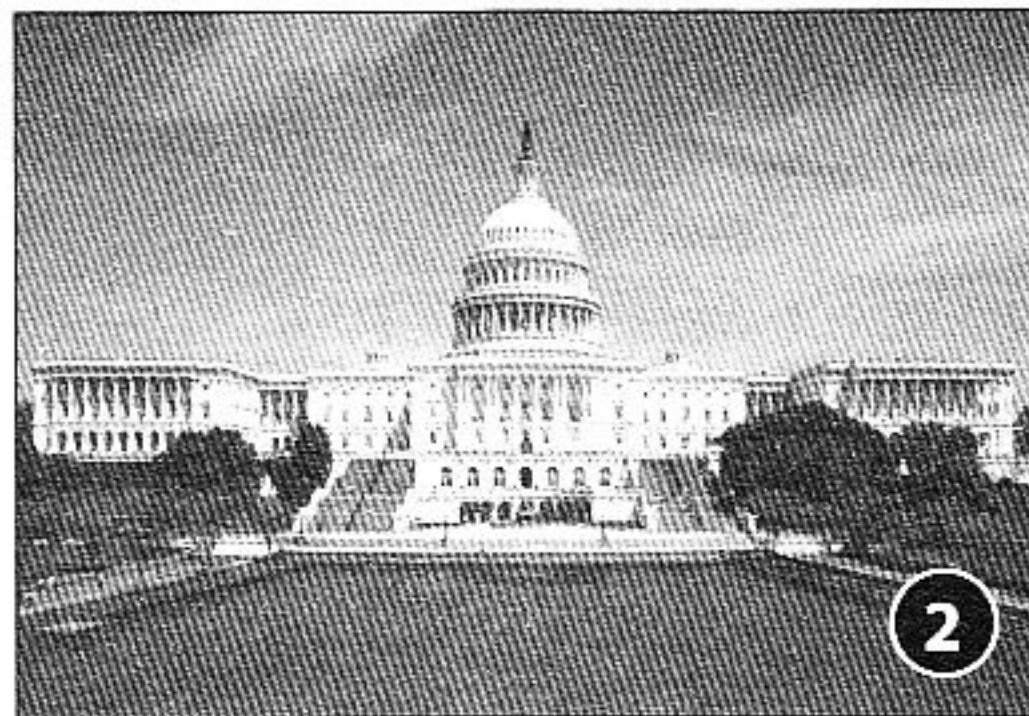
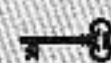
Washington, D. C. (District of Columbia) is the capital of the USA. Government buildings, such as *the White House*, the official residence of the U.S. president, *the Capitol*, the Congressional building and *the Supreme Court*, can be found there.

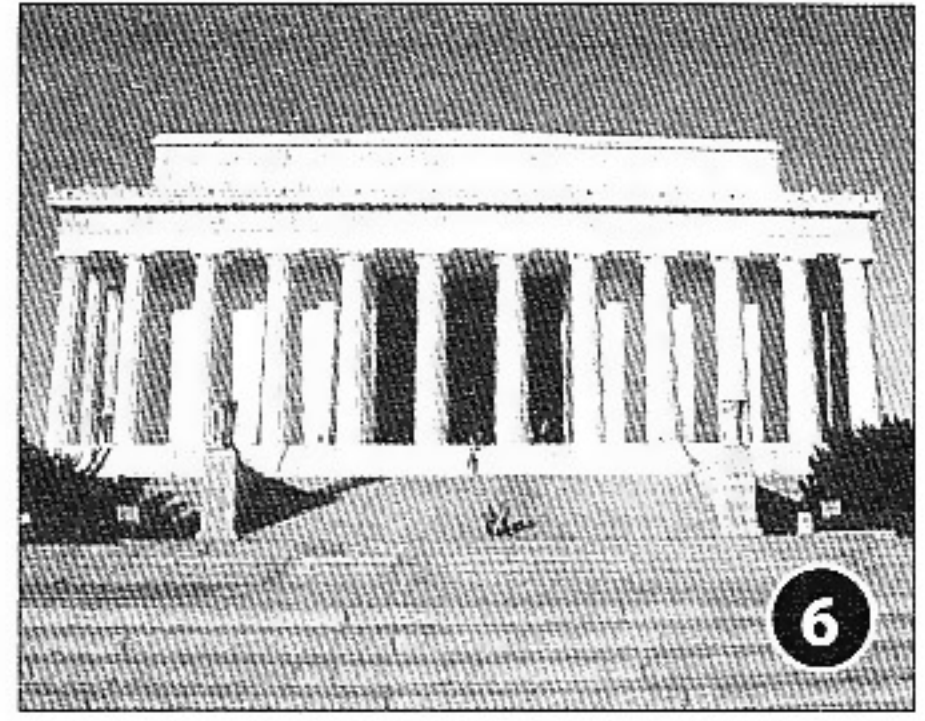
There are more than 300 memorials and statues in Washington of which the three most famous ones are *the Washington Monument*, *the Lincoln Memorial* and *the Jefferson Memorial*. *Georgetown*, situated to the west of the city, is the oldest and the most **prestigious** part and houses many foreign embassies. To the south-west there are *Arlington National Cemetery*, *Ronald Reagan Airport* and *the Pentagon*, the U.S. military **headquarters**.

Washington is also a major national centre of culture and education. There are four universities in Washington: *Georgetown University* (1815), which is Catholic, *George Washington University* (1821), *the American University* and *Howard University*, which was opened in 1860 as a university for Afro-American students.

Washington's principal cultural institutions are *the National Gallery of Art*, *the Smithsonian Institution* and *the Library of Congress*. *The Smithsonian Institution* is the world's largest museum complex of 15 museums and a zoo. It is an important centre for **research** into the arts, science and history. *The Library of Congress* is the largest U.S. library. It contains great collections of books, **manuscripts** and maps.

10. Can you label the sights in the pictures below with their names?
You can find them in the text. What have you learnt about them?





□ VOCABULARY LIST

accuracy [ækjərəsɪ] – presnosť

adventure – dobrodružstvo

along with – spolu s

arm – zbraň

assimilation [əsimileɪʃən] – prispôsobenie

to bury [berɪ] – pochovať

coronation – korunovácia

crowded – preplnený

crown jewels – korunovacie klenoty

excitement [ɪk'saɪtmənt] – vzrušenie

fortress – pevnosť

headquarters [hedkwɔ:təz] – veliteľstvo

including – vrátane

to lead [li:d] – viesť

manuscript – rukopis

mysterious – záhadný

to nickname – prezývať

nowadays – v dnešnej dobe

paradise – raj

peacefulness – mierumilovnosť

prestigious [pre'stɪdʒəs] – prestížny

reason [ri:zn] – dôvod

research – výskum

speech [spi:tʃ] – reč

tranquillity [træŋkwɪlɪti] – pokoj

unbounded [ʌn'baʊndɪd] – nespútany

waxwork – dielo z vosku

wild – divoký

wonder – div

at least – aspoň, prinajmenšom

a wide range of – široká škála

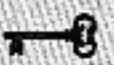
to be in session – zasadať

from time to time – z času na čas

the Supreme Court [sʌpri:m kɔ:t] – Najvyšší súd

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Read the definitions below and decide which places for living they best describe.



city – town – village – global city – hamlet – megacity – suburb

1. A _____ is a residential community of people ranging in population from a few hundred to several thousand. It is larger than a village but smaller than a city.

2. A _____ is usually larger and more important than a town. Skyscrapers, housing estates, business centres and shopping centres are typical. Infrastructure, such as roads, streets and public transport routes (metro rail system), are well-developed.
3. A _____, also known as a world city, is a main centre of trade, banking, finance, innovations and markets. It is a place with enormous power or influence.
4. A _____ refers to any city of enormous size, with a total population in excess of 10 million people. It is also known as a megapolis or megalopolis.
5. A _____ is a place with houses and other buildings (e.g. a church, a school, a pub, some shops), usually smaller than a town. It is usually situated on the outskirts of a city.
6. A _____ is normally found in rural areas. It is usually larger than a hamlet and smaller than a town or city.
7. A _____ is a small settlement, too small or unimportant to be considered a village.

Task 2 Add the words in column A to the words in column B to make logical word pairs.

→ 8

A

- Example:* job g
1. educational _____
 2. social _____
 3. football _____
 4. cultural _____
 5. theatre _____
 6. shopping _____
 7. railway _____
 8. heavy _____

B

- a) possibilities
- b) traffic
- c) station
- d) malls
- e) life
- f) performance
- g) opportunities
- h) events
- i) stadium

□ YOUR HOMEPLACE

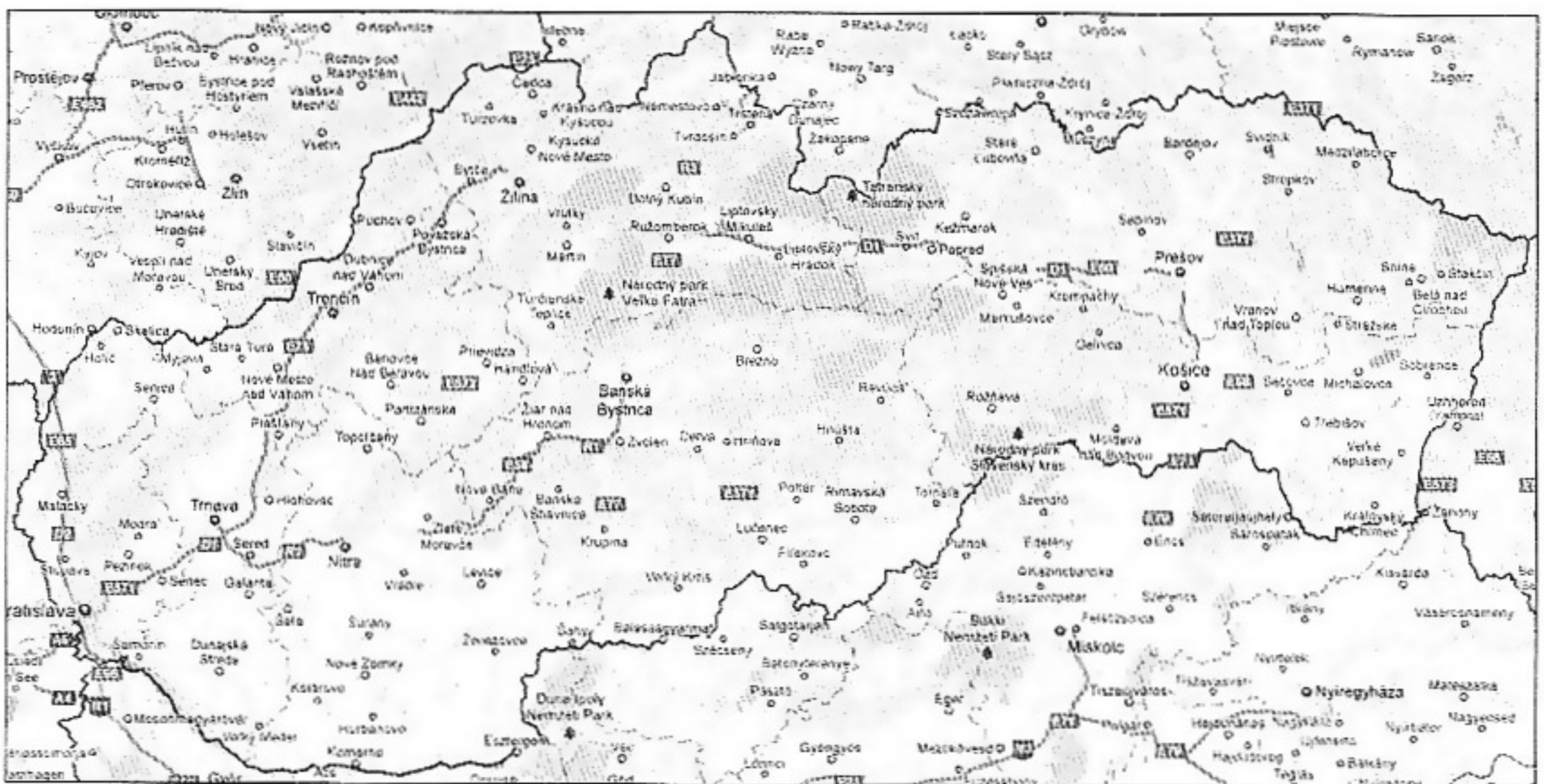
Task 7 Which of the following can be found in the place where you live?

art gallery – swimming pool – shopping centre – park – factory – football stadium – petrol station – zoo – university – bar – train station – castle – disco – museum – theatre – restaurant – river – bank – post office – cinema – hospital – hill – casino

Task 8 Which adjectives best describe your hometown/birthplace?

small – clean – agricultural – loud – medium-sized – famous – damaged – cheap – old – expensive – peaceful – safe – dangerous – large – hectic – historic – modern – crowded – isolated – industrial – reconstructed – densely populated

Task 9 Prepare a PowerPoint presentation on the most picturesque place to be visited in Slovakia. In your presentation, explain the reason for your choice and say what makes it so fascinating for you.



Task 10 Now, read the text about Slovakia to find out about interesting places. You, as a “tour guide”, are supposed to prepare an itinerary for a group of seven foreign teenage students who like hiking, cycling, climbing and caving. They are going to stay in Slovakia for five days. Decide, where you will start the trip and where you will finish it. Follow this plan:

DAY 1: _____

DAY 2: _____

DAY 3: _____

DAY 4: _____

DAY 5: _____

Slovakia offers many interesting places for relaxation. Beautiful countryside, caves, roaring waterfalls and vast plains attract many domestic and foreign tourists. *The High and Low Tatras* are great for spending active holiday during the whole year. Hiking, skiing, cross country skiing, cycling and horse riding are very popular among visiting tourists. *Podbanské* is one of the best-known tourist centres with hotels, shops, skiing centres, restaurants and cultural sites. *Tatranská Lomnica* offers a variety of types of accommodation, ski slopes, casinos, fitness centres, a horse-racing track and many other activities for tourists. *Veľká* and *Malá Studená Dolina*, with its waterfalls, is one of the most beautiful places for hiking. *Jánska Dolina* with its thermal swimming pools, *Chopok* (the second highest peak), *The National Park of the Low Tatras*, *Kráľova Hoľa*, *Demänovská Dolina* and *Demänovská Ice Cave* are the places which are visited very frequently. Slovakia is also famous for its many mineral and thermal springs. In 2004, storms devastated almost one third of the forests in *the High Tatras National Park*. To repair the damage it is possible to either replant the forests or let nature itself bring the area back to life. *Trenčianske Teplice*, *Bardejov*, *Sliac*, *Dudince*, *Smrdáky* and open air spas in the mountains of *Štrbské Pleso* and *Nový Smokovec* are annually visited by thousands of patients and visitors. The most famous spa is in *Piešťany*, with its mud bath procedures. Besides its natural attractions, Slovakia also offers many interesting places for sightseeing. The most beautiful castles are in *Orava*, *Spiš*, *Trenčín*, *Zvolen* and *Bojnice*. *Levoča*, an old town, is very famous for its beautiful wooden creations made by the woodcarver Master Paul. “The gold town”, *Kremnica*, and the “silver town”, *Banská Štiavnica*, are famous for their mining history. Slovakia also offers many cultural events for tourists. The folklore festivals in *Východná*, *Detva*, *Myjava* and elsewhere reflect cultural traditions preserved through folk songs and dances.